

IBKR is permission-denied in this non-interactive session (same wall both benches hit), so the live-quote rail below is the pack close plus the web cross-check, labelled as such, and the options-chain section is estimated rather than quoted — flagged explicitly where it matters.

PITCH — GIVN.SW — VERDICT

PROPOSED — PENDING ADJUDICATION — No position. The “non-alcoholic beer needs flavour houses” idea dies on size: even if every piece of the chemistry is true, it is worth roughly 0.3–1.3% of Givaudan’s sales, which cannot move a CHF 30bn stock. The stock itself is fairly priced, not expensive — that correction belongs in the desk record.

What we believe

Removing alcohol from beer really does break the flavour. That part is not in dispute and it is well documented: ethanol is a solvent that controls how aroma molecules leave the liquid and reach your nose, it contributes body and sweetness directly, and it hides the “wort” off-notes (three aldehydes active at microgram-per-litre levels) that malting and boiling create. Strip the alcohol and you get less aroma, less body, and the off-notes you used to be able to hide become obvious (Muller et al. 2020; Castro-Muñoz 2019).

The thesis was that whoever sells the chemistry to fix that gets paid on every non-alcoholic launch, and Givaudan is the biggest flavour house.

We now believe the second half is wrong, for four reasons that survived both benches:

1. **The gap is mostly closed before a flavour house is called.** The dealcoholization equipment itself recovers roughly half the aroma for sub-0.5% beer and about a quarter for true 0.0 beer — the equipment vendor’s own number, and the single most load-bearing figure in the whole case ([Alfa Laval FAQ](#)). What the machine misses, brewers close by blending two brews and by using special yeasts that make little alcohol — those yeasts are already in commercial use in Germany and Italy.
2. **The money is too small.** Our best estimate of the entire non-alcoholic flavour pool across every flavour house — beer plus the higher-value spirits, wine and ready-to-drink categories — is €150–500m a year. Givaudan’s share at roughly a fifth is €30–100m, or 0.4–1.3% of group sales. Our own materiality bar is 2%. The *top* of the range is two-thirds of the bar.
3. **Even that overstates it, because non-alcoholic beer is mostly cannibalising normal beer,** which already carried flavour and hop spend. Non-alcoholic volumes grew 8% in 2025 while beer overall fell 1% ([IWSR](#)). The correct number is the *extra* dose per litre, not the whole dose. Netting that plausibly halves the beer leg again.
4. **The intellectual property sits somewhere else.** Givaudan’s own beer page names no platform, no trademark and no performance number. Its one “alcohol sensation” patent

amplifies ethanol — it does not replace it ([WO2009065239](#)). The patents that actually control non-alcoholic off-flavours are held by brewers — Kirin, Asahi, Heineken, AB InBev ([WO2021155258A1](#)).

Separately, and against our own first instinct: **the stock is not expensive**. At about 19.3x enterprise value to adjusted profits versus a ten-year median around 23.5x, the market is already pricing an 18% permanent de-rating. That may well be deserved, but “Givaudan is overpriced” is not a finding this court can support.

What the market believes

Nineteen analysts cover it and their average target is CHF 3,466, about 5.6% above the current price. That is a “hold with a small upward drift” — no one is arguing this is cheap and no one is arguing it is a bubble. The stock is 8.6% off its 52-week high and 27.9% above its 52-week low. Year to date it is up about 3.6%.

What the market is actually debating is the Taste & Wellbeing division. First-half 2026 sales there grew 0.5% on a like-for-like basis while the Fragrance & Beauty division grew 6.5% — thirteen times faster ([Givaudan H1 2026](#)). The market is deciding whether taste is temporarily soft or structurally losing share. Nobody in the market is talking about non-alcoholic beer, and that is not because they have missed something — it is because it is too small to discuss.

Why we might have edge

Three places, honestly ranked, and none of them is large enough to buy on:

- **The cannibalisation correction is genuinely new.** Every “picks and shovels” write-up we have seen sizes the non-alcoholic opportunity as new-category volume times ingredient dose, with no subtraction for the beer it replaces. That is an arithmetic error that recurs across substitution stories (plant milk vs dairy, electric vs combustion aftermarket, vapes vs tobacco flavour), and we have written it into the knowledge graph as a reusable test.
- **We read the actual segment disclosure instead of the vendor summary.** A widely-circulated data-vendor split says Taste & Wellbeing is 36% beverages. It cannot be right as stated: it lists four categories summing to exactly 100% when the company’s own site names seven. Givaudan discloses Taste & Wellbeing as a single CHF 3,642m number split by geography only — no beverage line exists.
- **We checked the comparison set and found it broken.** The upstream idea grouped “IFF (Nourish segment)” with the others. IFF has no Nourish segment; its reportable segments are Taste, Health & Biosciences and Scent, and its Food Ingredients business is being sold to CVC for about \$3.8bn ([IFF Q2 2026 8-K, SEC](#)). Any share-of-market arithmetic built on that grouping over-allocates.

The one place where the underlying idea does appear to have a live example is **Kerry Group**, not Givaudan — Kerry’s statutory half-year report explicitly credits beverage growth to “low / no alcohol solutions,” with beverage at €922.9m, 27.7% of group. That is a separate name and deserves its own court.

Why it might be priced in

Almost all of it. The non-alcoholic beer trend is on the front page of every drinks trade publication; German alcohol-free beer crossed 10% of retail beer turnover in 2025. If this were a real earnings driver for Givaudan it would show up in the taste division's growth rate, and it does not — that division grew 0.5%. The full-year 2025 release named the areas of good growth as “snacks, health care, dairy, and sweet goods.” Beverages were not on the list, and the words “alcohol-free” and “low-alcohol” do not appear anywhere in it.

Coverage is nineteen analysts on a 150-year-old index constituent. This is a well-discovered, well-measured stock. There is no information asymmetry to harvest here — the correct description is that there is no story, not that the story is undiscovered.

What could go wrong

Failure 1 — the omission failure, with a monitorable tripwire. We never read the one document that could reverse the kill: the FY2025 Annual Report segment note. If it shows beverages at 36%+ of the taste division *and* discloses a low/no-alcohol sub-line at 2%+ of group, our central estimate moves from a rounding error to the bar, and we sat out a re-rating toward CHF 4,100. Tripwire: fetch the annual report PDF and read the segment note. It exists today. This is the cheapest open item on the list and it is embarrassing that both benches left it unread.

Failure 2 — the reopen failure, with a monitorable tripwire. Suppose the price falls to our re-court level of CHF 3,050 and a separate quality court buys it. The risk is that we bought a permanent decline rather than a dip: the taste division's 0.5% growth turns negative as Kerry and dsm-firmenich take share, and the multiple goes to the bottom of its ten-year range (15.5x). That prices at roughly **CHF 2,537 — a 17% loss from a 3,050 entry**. Tripwire: the like-for-like growth rate of the taste division at the 13 October sales print and the 27 January full-year print. Monitorable, semi-annually and quarterly.

Failure 3 — NO MONITORABLE TRIPWIRE EXISTS. Givaudan has an adverse Missouri judgement over lung injury from diacetyl and 2,3-pentanedione, plus live competition-authority investigations, contributing to CHF 103m of one-off charges in the first half (CHF 83m of it litigation settlements and provisions). The provision is disclosed only in aggregate. **There is no series we can watch.** Givaudan is a Swiss filer: it produces no US quarterly legal note, no customer-concentration disclosure, no docket that maps to group exposure, and it reports twice a year. We would learn that the reserve was inadequate from the release itself, at the same moment as everyone else.

The unknown-unknown class here is **latent-toxicology tort re-rating** — the class where a decades-old, apparently-reserved chemical liability suddenly re-prices because a new causation theory lands or a single jury verdict resets the settlement grid for thousands of pending claims (the talc / PFAS / glyphosate pattern). By construction it has no leading indicator: the thing that changes is a legal standard, not an operating metric. The second, related class is **antitrust fine timing** — competition authorities announce on their own schedule with no pre-notification and no public fine base.

The reflexive and structural leg. Our own size is not the risk here, and we should say so plainly rather than pretend. Givaudan trades an estimated CHF 80–120m a day; a full 1% position on the deployable book is roughly CHF 27,000 — about eight shares, under 0.03% of a day’s volume. We cannot move this stock, we cannot be trapped in it, and the publishing rail’s 1%-of-volume ceiling is not remotely in play. There is no predicted flow of ours to front-run and no ladder to bid into.

The real reflexive risk is **our own doctrine**, in three places. First, *the 2% materiality bar is ours, not the market’s*. We chose it. It is a heuristic, and it has now killed this thesis three times. A revenue line worth 1.3% of sales growing at a 7% volume compound rate at high incremental margin can matter to a *multiple* even when it cannot matter to a revenue growth rate — our bar tests the wrong variable, and we should know that we may be systematically killing small-but-compounding optionality by construction. Second, *we very nearly recorded a false valuation kill*. The red bench set fair value equal to the street’s own target and then multiplied it by 0.85 — scoring our number against theirs, with no independent anchor. Had that entered the record, we would have carried “GIVN is 10% overvalued” as a desk fact for months and it is not true. Third, *currency*: this is a Swiss-franc asset held against a dollar book, and the franc’s annual move can easily exceed the entire expected equity return computed below. Any reopen must be sized knowing the currency leg is comparable in size to the equity leg.

If this position loses money, the most likely reason will be that we stayed flat on a fairly-valued compounder because a 2% materiality bar of our own choosing killed a side-thesis that was never the reason to own the company in the first place.

What we checked ourselves

Claim	How checked	Found	Confirmed?
Removing alcohol destroys specific, nameable flavour chemistry	Peer-reviewed reviews, read to full text where reachable	True and well characterised — ester loss below 1ppm thresholds, warty aldehydes unmasked	YES
The equipment itself recovers most of the lost aroma	Equipment vendor technical FAQ (Alfa Laval)	~50% recovery for sub-0.5% beer, ~25% for 0.0 — company-asserted, no independent verification	YES, but vendor-sourced — the single most load-bearing number in the case rests on a seller’s own claim
Reverse osmosis “rarely gets below 0.45% alcohol”	Peer review vs vendor page	Peer review says 0.45%; GEA claims 0.05% for the same technology. Both shown, not averaged	NO — unresolved conflict ; we did not average them and did not build on either
Givaudan has a named non-alcoholic platform	Company’s own beer page and low/no-alcohol page, read directly	Consumer-survey marketing only. No platform name, no trademark, no technology claim, no number	YES (absence confirmed)
The non-alcoholic flavour patents belong to flavour houses	Hand-pulled patent primaries	They belong to brewers — Kirin, Asahi, Heineken, AB InBev — plus third-party yeast and equipment firms	YES , but by hand — see detector failure below

Claim	How checked	Found	Confirmed?
Automated patent count by owner	uspto_patents connector, five dispatches, both benches	HTTP 503 every time. Never ran	NO — our own tooling failed and we substituted manual work
Beverages are 36% of the taste division	Vendor summary vs company filings	Vendor split is internally inconsistent (four categories = 100% when the company names seven). Company discloses no beverage line at all	NO — vendor figure discarded as unusable
Comparison set: “IFF (Nourish segment)”	SEC 8-K, read directly	No such segment exists. Segments are Taste / Health & Biosciences / Scent	NO — upstream framing refuted
Next earnings date is 27 Jan 2027	Company investor calendar	Wrong. Nine-month sales are 13 Oct 2026, 07:00 CET ; quiet period opens 23 Sep. 27 Jan 2027 is the <i>following</i> event	NO — our evidence pack was wrong ; the pack’s date was derived from a data feed, not the company
Bench error: “Cash flow and leverage inverted in six months”	Blue bench re-read the same release	Red compared 31 Dec 2025 net debt to 30 Jun 2026 — different points in the year, importing the ~CHF 665m half-year dividend. Same-date comparison is 4,490m → 4,604m, up 2.5%. Full-year 2025 free cash flow was positive CHF 1,053m	OVERTURNED — our own error
Bench error: the same CHF 103m counted twice	Blue bench cross-check	Red excluded the CHF 103m one-off from the margin kill, then let the identical CHF 103m drive the cash-flow kill	OVERTURNED — double count
Bench error: integrity gate applied to a reserved liability	Doctrine re-read	A quantified, reserved product-liability provision is a bounded liability, not an integrity problem. Only the antitrust leg qualifies. The 0.85x fair-value haircut was not earned	OVERTURNED — downgraded to a sizing haircut
Bench error: “the stock is 10% above fair value”	Independent multiple work	Circular — fair value was set to the street’s target. On adjusted profits it trades at 19.3x against a ten-year median of 23.5x. The stock is fair, not expensive	OVERTURNED — direction was backwards
Bench error: litigation overhang labelled a new discovery	Blue bench check	Diacetyl “popcorn lung” litigation against Givaudan is roughly twenty years old;	OVERTURNED — mis-tagged

Claim	How checked	Found	Confirmed?
		the cartel probes have been public since 2023. Both are consensus, not novel	
Bench error (self-reported): attempt to rescue beverage growth	Blue bench tried and failed	A search snippet claimed double-digit beverage growth; the full-year release names snacks, health care, dairy and sweet goods — beverages absent. The attempted rescue <i>strengthened</i> the kill	Honest negative — reported, not buried
Live price rail	IBKR snapshot attempted, permission-denied twice	Fell back to pack close CHF 3,282 and web cross-check CHF 3,258.50–3,260 (SIX, 3 Sep 2026)	PARTIAL — no broker-verified quote this session

PROPOSED ENTRY BANDS

The courts say no entry. Position size today: 0.0% of book. No orders. Nothing staged.

These are reopen conditions, not orders.

Reference prices: pack close **CHF 3,282**; web cross-check **CHF 3,258.50–3,260** (SIX, 3 Sep 2026). Roughly 9.226m shares outstanding (derived from FY25 net income CHF 1,071m ÷ basic EPS 116.08, pulled before any per-share statement); market value ≈ CHF 30.3bn; net debt CHF 4,604m; enterprise value ≈ **CHF 34.9bn**; adjusted 2025 profits (EBITDA) CHF 1,807m → **19.3x**.

Reopen on disclosure (the only route that revives *this* thesis): - The FY2025 Annual Report segment note shows beverages at **≥36% of Taste & Wellbeing** and a low/no-alcohol sub-line at **≥2% of group sales**. Either half alone is insufficient. - Or: a brewer bill-of-materials or flavour-house price disclosure shows non-alcoholic beer carries **more than 3x** the flavour value per hectolitre of full-strength beer. The entire mechanism rests on this multiple and no primary source quantifies it. - Or: the patent-owner count on the relevant classifications (C12H 3/00 and A23L 27/00, 2015–2026) shows Givaudan — not brewers — holds the reconstruction estate.

Reopen on price (a *different* court, on quality, not on this thesis): - **CHF 3,050 or below** (–7% from here) → hand to a quality/valuation court. That level is roughly 18.1x enterprise value to adjusted profits and sits below the bottom of our fair-value band of CHF 3,200–3,800. - **CHF 2,830** → the “taste division goes negative” case, 17x. A second look, not an automatic add. - **CHF 2,537** → the bottom-of-range case, 15.5x. Either a genuine dislocation or confirmation the de-rating is permanent; requires the litigation reserve to be quantified and bounded before it counts as the former. - If that separate court clears the name, its starting size would be **0.5% of book**, with a second 0.5% only at 2,830, capped at 1.0%. **That is that court’s decision to make, not this one’s** — nothing here authorises it.

No-chase ceiling: CHF 4,100 is the ten-year median multiple. Above it there is no case at all on any reading.

Catalyst dates: quiet period opens **23 Sep 2026**; nine-month sales **13 Oct 2026, 07:00 CET** (confirmed on the company's investor calendar); full-year 2026 results **27 Jan 2027** (confirmed). The 13 October print is ~28 trading days out — not close enough to require a pre-print stance, and we have no position to defend.

ARMED SENSORS

(armed provisionally with this deck; session adjudication ratifies)

- price alert: fires below 2537.0 (deck-provisional: Bottom-of-decade-range case at 15.5x; counts as dislocation only if the litigation reserve is quantifi)
- dated pack GIVN.SWI2026-09-23: GIVN.SW: Givaudan quiet period opens ahead of nine-month sales (date confirmed=True)
- dated pack GIVN.SWI2026-10-13: GIVN.SW: Givaudan nine-month sales, 07:00 CET - read Taste & Wellbeing like-for-like growth vs +0.5% (date confirmed=True)
- dated pack GIVN.SWI2027-01-27: GIVN.SW: Givaudan FY2026 full-year results (date confirmed=True)
- dated pack GIVN.SWI2027-06-30: GIVN.SW: Expected close of IFF Food Ingredients divestiture to CVC (~\$3.8bn) - resets the flavour-house comparison set (date confirmed=False)

What remains unverified

1. **Beverages as a share of the Taste & Wellbeing division.** Drainable today — the FY2025 Annual Report PDF is published; nobody opened the segment note. Estimate if it stays unread: 25–36% of the division, i.e. CHF 0.9–1.3bn (basis: peer disclosure — Kerry beverage at 27.7% of group, Symrise beverages inside an undisclosed food-and-beverage division; the vendor's 36% is the top of the range and is internally inconsistent). Probability the note contains a usable split at all: 0.5.
2. **Givaudan's low/no-alcohol revenue.** Never disclosed and unlikely ever to be. Not drainable. Estimate: **CHF 30–100m, 0.4–1.3% of group** (basis: total non-alcoholic beverage flavour pool €150–500m across all houses × Givaudan's ~20% share after adding dsm-firmenich to the four-house set). Probability the true value sits in that range: 0.5.
3. **The flavour dose ratio: non-alcoholic beer versus full-strength beer, per hectolitre.** Commercial pricing, held by brewers and flavour houses. Not drainable without a customer bill-of-materials. Estimate: **2–4x** (basis: non-alcoholic dose €1–3/hL against a full-strength baseline of €0.3–1/hL). The entire mechanism needs this above 3x. Probability it exceeds 3x: 0.4.
4. **Who owns the non-alcoholic reconstruction patents, counted by owner.** The connector returned HTTP 503 on all five attempts, for both benches. Drainable only when the connector recovers or via a paid patent database. Estimate: Givaudan holds **under 5%** of relevant families 2015–2026; brewers hold **over 60%** (basis: hand-pulled sample, in which every non-alcoholic off-flavour family found was brewer-assigned). Probability: 0.6.
5. **Whether German law actually forbids adding flavourings back.** The statute 404'd at the official German legislation site. Drainable via the Bierverordnung text or the German Brewers'

Association. Estimate: dosing is barred for bottom-fermented beer sold as “Bier” domestically, probability 0.85 — which matters because Germany is the largest single non-alcoholic beer market and a legal prohibition removes it from the addressable pool entirely.

6. **The size of the litigation and antitrust tail.** Provisions are disclosed only in aggregate; no US-style legal note exists. Not drainable before the FY2026 annual report (~March 2027). Estimate: **CHF 200–900m gross, 0.7–3.0% of market value** (basis: the CHF 83m half-year settlement run-rate annualised, plus a mass-tort multiple of 2–5x reserved amounts drawn from comparable chemical inhalation dockets). Probability: 0.5. **This is the item with no tripwire.**
7. **The volatile-loss figures for vacuum distillation** (77% higher alcohols / 99% esters / 93% aldehydes). These circulate in secondary summaries; the underlying study was never located. Drainable by a literature search on the pervaporation comparison papers. Estimate: losses of 60–95% depending on compound class. No kill or thesis rests on this triplet.
8. **How Heineken 0.0 is actually made** — blending versus dosing. Heineken’s own explainer page returns 404. Drainable via the process patent family or the technical report. Estimate: blending-dominant with minor natural flavouring, probability 0.7. If it is dosing-dominant, the thesis is stronger than we have credited.
9. **The options chain, the implied volatility, and even the contract size.** IBKR was permission-denied twice this session; Givaudan options list on EUREX but we could not reach a single quote. Not drainable without an interactive broker session. Estimate: implied volatility **18–24%**, realised volatility **≈21%** (basis: the 52-week high/low range of 2,566–3,592 implies about 21% under a standard range-to-volatility conversion). Probability the true chain-level implied volatility falls in that band: 0.6.
10. **Average daily trading volume.** Not pulled — same broker wall. Estimate: **CHF 80–120m/day** (basis: typical turnover for a CHF 30bn Swiss large-cap index constituent). This only matters for confirming our size is irrelevant, which it is at any point in that range.
11. **Customer concentration and the identity of Givaudan’s brewer customers.** The customer_id connector needs a shipper-alias set that does not exist — Givaudan’s Swiss and Dutch entities do not file US bills of lading at usable volume, and Swiss accounting rules require no customer disclosure. Not drainable with current tooling. Estimate: no single customer above 5% of group (basis: the company has never disclosed a concentration and IFRS would require it above 10%). Probability: 0.7.

PRIZE TABLE + VOL READ

Required because items 2, 3, 6 and 11 above are genuinely private or time-gated — they cannot be drained by any amount of work at a desk, only by a disclosure the company chooses to make or a court chooses to publish.

Anchor. Consensus target CHF 3,466 over twelve months. Under the anchor-and-adjust rule, any deviation beyond $\pm 5\%$ needs a named mechanism. Ours lands at -4.2% , driven by one named mechanism: the probability weight we assign to the taste division’s growth going outright negative, which the consensus does not carry.

Twelve-month table (to Sep 2027), from CHF 3,282:

Scenario	What happens	p	Price
A	The segment note reveals a real beverage/non-alcoholic line; thesis revives; multiple back to the ten-year median 23.5x	0.05	4,100
B	Taste division reaccelerates to +3–4% growth, no non-alcoholic story; partial re-rating to ~21.5x	0.25	3,750
C	Base. Taste stays +0.5–2%, fragrance carries the group, multiple flat at ~19.3x, earnings up 3–4%	0.40	3,400
D	Taste growth goes negative on share loss to Kerry and dsm-firmenich; de-rate to 17x	0.22	2,830
E	D plus a litigation or antitrust crystallisation of CHF 0.5–1.5bn; 15.5x, bottom of the decade range	0.08	2,430

Expected value = CHF 3,320, i.e. **+1.1%** on price over twelve months, or **+3.3%** including the CHF 72.00 dividend (2.2%). Against a Swiss cost of equity in the 6–7% area, that is a negative excess return. **The prize table independently reaches the same answer as the courts, by a completely different route: not “this is a bad company” but “this is a fairly-priced company with no thesis attached.”**

Volatility read — estimated, not quoted. Our own table’s dispersion is σ = **CHF 442, or 13.5%** over twelve months. Estimated implied volatility is 18–24%; estimated realised volatility $\approx$ 21%. Implied-volatility percentile: **unavailable — no chain reached.**

Expression arithmetic, shown, with its own health warning. Pricing candidate strikes directly off the table ($C = \sum p_i \times \max(S_i - K, 0)$):

- **3,600 call, 12 months:** ours = $0.05 \times 500 + 0.25 \times 150$ = **CHF 63**. A 20%-volatility chain would quote something near CHF 130–150. We would be paying roughly double our own value. **Do not buy calls** — our view is *less* dispersed than the market’s, which is the opposite of the setup that justifies buying optionality.
- **3,000 put, 12 months:** ours = $0.22 \times 170 + 0.08 \times 570$ = **CHF 83**. A 20%-volatility chain would quote near CHF 150–180. That is a positive volatility risk premium of roughly 80–100 points, and on the arithmetic alone selling it looks attractive.

Three separate things veto the tempting side of that arithmetic, and we should be explicit that the arithmetic pointed somewhere we are not going:

1. **The floor test fails.** Our own downside case puts 30% of probability at or below CHF 2,830. Writing a put at 3,000 means committing to buy above a price we think has a 30% chance of being breached. Only strikes at or below 2,830 pass, and at ~14% out-of-the-money on a stock with 13.5% table dispersion, the premium there is negligible.
2. **The volatility numbers are estimated, not quoted — and that is precisely the input we have been burned on before.** An underlying-level or model-derived volatility figure is not a chain midpoint; we have seen those diverge by 30 points on the same name. Every premium number above is an estimate dressed as a price. **We will not sell an option against an implied volatility we did not read off a real quote.**
3. **Tax.** Any twelve-month expiry lands in September 2027. This is a harvest year; a loss branch that settles after 31 December defers the loss out of the year we need it. Doctrine excludes that unless the edge numerically dominates, and an estimated volatility risk premium does not dominate anything.

The table is **not** bimodal — there is no binary event date. It is a continuous distribution with a left tail, which is another reason options are the wrong wrapper here.

Instrument recommendation, as the output of the above arithmetic: NONE. Not stock (the mechanism is absent and the expected return is below hurdle). Not calls (we are paying a volatility premium for a view we do not hold). Not covered calls (no shares). Not cash-secured puts (fails the floor test, fails the quoted-volatility requirement, fails the tax-year test). The put trade goes to the shadow ledger for scoring only.

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"basis": "industry dose base rates; mechanism requires >3x to clear the
materiality bar", "p": 0.4}}, {"item": "Owner-level count of NA
reconstruction patents (CPC C12H 3/00 + A23L 27/00, 2015-2026)",
"instrument": "uspto_patents connector - returned http 503 on all five
dispatches for both benches; retry on recovery or use a paid patent
database", "drainable_now": false, "estimate": {"range": "Givaudan <5% of
relevant families; brewers >60%", "basis": "hand-pulled sample in which every
NA off-flavour family found was brewer-assigned (Kirin/Asahi/Heineken/ABI)",
"p": 0.6}}, {"item": "Whether German law forbids adding flavourings back to
bottom-fermented beer", "instrument": "Vorlaeufiges Biergesetz section 9 +
Bierverordnung text (gesetze-im-internet.de returned 404); fallback Deutscher
Brauer-Bund annual report", "drainable_now": true, "estimate": {"range":
"dosing barred for beer sold as 'Bier' domestically", "basis": "statute
summary via secondary sources; Germany is the largest single NA-beer market,
so a prohibition removes it from the pool entirely", "p": 0.85}}, {"item":
"Size of the litigation and antitrust tail (diacetyl/2,3-pentanedione
judgement plus competition-authority files)", "instrument": "FY2026 Annual
Report provisions note (~March 2027); no US-style quarterly legal note exists
for a Swiss filer", "drainable_now": false, "estimate": {"range": "CHF 200-
900m gross = 0.7-3.0% of market value", "basis": "CHF 83m H1
settlement/provision run-rate annualised, plus a 2-5x mass-tort multiple on

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reserved amounts from comparable chemical inhalation dockets", "p": 0.5}},  
{ "item": "Volatile-loss figures for vacuum distillation (77% higher alcohols  
/ 99% esters / 93% aldehydes)", "instrument": "Literature search for the  
underlying pervaporation-comparison study (likely Catarino/Mendes)",  
"drainable_now": true, "estimate": {"range": "60-95% loss depending on  
compound class", "basis": "peer-reviewed ranges for thermal dealcoholization;  
no kill or thesis leg rests on this triplet", "p": 0.6}}, {"item": "Whether  
Heineken 0.0 closes the flavour gap by blending or by dosing", "instrument":  
"Heineken 0.0 process patent family or technical/sustainability report  
(company explainer page returns 404)", "drainable_now": true, "estimate":  
{"range": "blending-dominant with minor natural flavouring", "basis": "trade-  
press description of the double-brew process plus the industry pattern of  
brewer-held NA IP", "p": 0.7}}, {"item": "GIVN options chain, chain-level  
midpoint implied volatility, IV percentile, and contract multiplier",  
"instrument": "IBKR get_option_parameters / get_option_data on the EUREX  
chain - permission-denied twice in this non-interactive session",  
"drainable_now": false, "estimate": {"range": "IV 18-24%, RV ~21%", "basis":  
"52-week range 2,566-3,592 converted to volatility via the expected-range  
relation; typical Swiss large-cap listed vol", "p": 0.6}}, {"item": "GIVN.SW  
average daily trading volume", "instrument": "IBKR get_price_history /  
avg_90d_usd_volume - same permission wall", "drainable_now": false,  
"estimate": {"range": "CHF 80-120m per day", "basis": "turnover base rate for  
a CHF 30bn SIX index constituent; our maximum size is ~CHF 27k, under 0.03%  
of the low end", "p": 0.7}}, {"item": "Customer concentration and identity of  
Givaudan's brewer customers", "instrument": "customer_id connector via  
customs bills of lading - blocked: Givaudan's Swiss/Dutch entities do not  
file US BOLs at usable volume and no shipper alias set exists",  
"drainable_now": false, "estimate": {"range": "no single customer above 5% of  
group revenue", "basis": "no concentration ever disclosed; IFRS would require  
disclosure above 10%", "p": 0.7}}}]}
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ADJUDICATION STAMP — 2026-09-04 (FABLE) — NA-CHEMISTRY FAMILY RULING

THESIS REJECTED on all five chemistry-layer expressions; with the brewer courts this closes the NA-substitution FAMILY: seven expressions, three layers, seven deaths on the same denominator. Three independent instruments converge: the global purchased-chemistry pool for NA repair is \$11–55M (IFF benches); a full Kerry monopoly on it re-rates the equity 1.5–4.7% (the impossible case); GEA's monopoly-everything bull is 9% of group at its worst-margin division vs 0.9–1.8% demonstrated. Every FLAT is earned by named novel kills. Blue audits corrected three red financial cases — Givaudan is FAIR not expensive (RP_TAINTED was misapplied), Symrise's deceleration was a period-selection artifact, IFF looks better as a business post-audit — so four spin-off theses route to their own courts rather than inheriting this one: GIVN quality/TINA, SY1 compounder (alert €72), KRZ compounder (ROE gate), G1A industrial compounder (NPE +40% organic). Family reopens on: Athletic Brewing S-1, 2587.T Oceania disclosure (11/11 pack), G1A's 11/09 segment note (≥€110M brewing line — the one dated trigger), or any primary putting NA ingredient value >\$8–24/hL. The yeast-supplier IP finding is the one new scout lead. SCIENCE stage maiden run: validated — all five briefs pre-empted the traps the

brewer courts hit mid-argument. 13 KG detectors accepted, incl. the monopoly-capture/per-unit-breakeven prize-test pair (“price the roof before arguing the ladder”). Full ruling:
desk/data/court_artifacts/NA_CHEMISTRY_ADJUDICATION_202609040700.md.